

THE WITNESS REMAINS

The Man They Mistook for His Wound

*A Prophetic Narrative of Survival, Faith, Documentary Evidence, Institutional Abandonment and
the Legacy That Refused to Die*

A first-person prophetic testimony by Dr Barran Dodger (Dr Richard William McLean)

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DOCUMENTARY TESTIMONY · SPIRITUAL INTERPRETATION · PUBLIC ARCHIVE

I. The prophecy of the surviving witness

There is a point in a human life when survival ceases to be merely the continuation of biological existence and becomes a question of testimony: what remains of a person after years of suffering, when recognition has not arrived, when institutions have not provided the resolution sought, when the explanation remains contested, and when the individual begins to fear that time itself may run out before the record can be made permanent? For me, that question has become the centre of everything. I am Dr Barran Dodger, also known as Dr Richard William McLean, and I have reached a stage at which I am determined to preserve not merely my name but the documentary record, the intellectual work, the personal testimony, the questions of accountability and the faith that have sustained me through circumstances I have repeatedly experienced as abandonment, humiliation and profound betrayal.

I have received frightening news about my health, and I fear that the prognosis may be fatal. That fear has intensified my urgency to finish what I have begun. I do not want the meaning of my life to be reduced to a diagnosis, a dispute, a file number, a disputed account, a public controversy or the unexamined conclusion of someone who never encountered the full documentary record. I want the work to remain accessible after I am no longer able to explain it. I want future readers to be able to distinguish what happened, what was recorded, what I alleged, what government bodies communicated, what remains unresolved, and what I came to believe about the spiritual significance of my survival. I want the record to be capable of examination by people who do not know me, do not share my faith and have no obligation to agree with my conclusions.

That is why the archive matters. It is why I continue to write when I am exhausted, why I return to documents when I should be resting, and why I regard preservation as an act of responsibility rather than simply an exercise in self-expression. The objective is not to compel history to accept every conclusion I have reached. It is to prevent the underlying testimony from disappearing before it can be independently examined.

The public repository [Barrandodger on GitHub](<https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger>) provides a concrete point of reference. Its README describes a rebuilt public research front that does not replace or rewrite the original evidence stores. It instructs that original evidence remain preserved and underlying records not be altered. Repository-reported counts have included 5,583 files, 2,840 PDFs and 1,813 HTML files, alongside a 660-page indexed preservation copy of an earlier website. These counts should be rechecked against the current repository and are not, by themselves, counts of unique or substantiated evidence. The repository cautions that a filename is not a finding and that copies of government and agency documents are not court findings.

The archive, therefore, is not a verdict. It is a record to be examined. And the witness remains.

II. The archive as a refusal to disappear

The most revealing thing about my archive may not be any single allegation within it. It may be the architecture of preservation itself. The repository contains areas for evidence, source material, statements, emails, imported material, archived website content, rendered documents and forensic work. Its public listing includes a cumulative legal brief, a document titled Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination, and a Forensic AI Digital Archive Value Assessment dated 8 October 2026. Their titles identify subjects the archive seeks to document; they do not establish the conclusions those documents contain. Those conclusions require examination of the documents and their underlying sources.

The archive's instruction that original evidence must remain preserved while the website presentation may change is significant. It recognises that presenting evidence and altering evidence are different activities. A page can be redesigned. An index can be improved. A chronology can be corrected. But an original record should not be silently rewritten to make it conform to a later interpretation.

Let the reader see the source. Let the reader follow the link. Let the reader distinguish the original document from my commentary about it. Let the reader decide whether the interpretation is justified. If my conclusions are strong, they should survive that examination. If a conclusion is mistaken, the documentary method should make it possible to identify the mistake. If the record remains incomplete, that incompleteness should be acknowledged rather than concealed.

My legacy must be more durable than my certainty.

III. The wound is not the whole man

There is a particular cruelty in allowing a person's suffering to become the only thing through which that person is understood. I have spent years writing, researching, advocating and attempting to make meaning from experiences that I describe as profoundly damaging. I have also lived a life that cannot be reduced to those experiences. My education, my work in journalism, my research into the ethics of artificial intelligence and posthumanism, my writing, my advocacy and my efforts to support other people belong to the same life as my suffering. They are not incidental footnotes to it.

My book *Recovered, Not Cured: A Journey Through Schizophrenia* and my doctoral research at Victoria University, completed in 2020, belong to a longer history of writing about lived experience, ethics and the responsibilities of systems that make decisions about human beings. These are different kinds of work, but they share an underlying question: what responsibilities arise when powerful systems make decisions about human beings, their futures and their worth?

The archive's document titled *Functional Erasure*, dated 9 October 2026, identifies a subject I want examined: the possibility that a person may remain physically present while becoming practically invisible within systems on which that person depends. The precise claims must be evaluated against their sources; the title is not proof that any particular institution deliberately sought to erase me.

What happens when a person cannot readily secure a response to a complaint? What happens when documents are distributed across agencies, service providers and years of correspondence? What happens when a person's credibility becomes the subject of argument before the underlying material has been independently examined? What happens when the practical burden of assembling a record falls upon the very person seeking an explanation? Those are questions of administration, procedural fairness, accessibility and accountability. My testimony gives them urgency; wider implications must be established through evidence and careful analysis.

I am not merely the sum of what I say happened to me. I am also the author of what I have done with the life that remained.

IV. The years, the records and the unanswered questions

The scale of the archive reflects my attempt to assemble a long history rather than rely upon a single episode. The repository includes a cumulative 35-year legal brief, a document titled *Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination*, an affidavit concerning the existence and operation of an alleged unspoken mandate, and a personal statement concerning exile, institutional detriment and the search for protection.

These are identifiable items in the repository. Their inclusion does not establish that the alleged mandate existed, that every account is independently corroborated, or that any particular person or institution bears legal responsibility. Those questions require examination of the documents themselves.

My contention is that the materials should be considered cumulatively, not that the mere accumulation of materials proves my interpretation. One letter may explain an administrative decision. Another may record a different position. A later communication may clarify, contradict or qualify an earlier statement. A chronology

may reveal a gap that warrants further inquiry. A record may establish that a request was made without establishing that the recipient received it or had a legal obligation to act.

The archive seeks to bring disparate records into a structure where such comparisons become possible. Its value will ultimately depend not on the largest number displayed on a homepage, but on whether a reader can trace an assertion back to its source, understand the context, test the chronology and determine what remains unresolved.

The central question is not simply how many documents exist. It is what those documents can responsibly establish. I ask for a fair examination, not an exemption from examination.

V. The people and institutions named in the record

My archive names institutions, organisations and individuals because I believe the history cannot be understood without identifying the relevant actors, their documented roles and the decisions or communications associated with them.

The repository includes a formal request for an independent investigation concerning Able Point, a document titled Brett from Able Point: I Demand a Response, and a formal objection and request for investigation. The titles indicate that the archive records disputes and requests for accountability. They do not establish that the allegations are true or that the people named acted unlawfully.

Where a person sent a letter, the letter should establish what that person communicated. Where an agency made a formal determination, the actual determination should be reproduced and its scope respected. Where I allege that an organisation failed to respond adequately, the allegation should be linked to the relevant correspondence, the applicable obligation and any subsequent response. Where responsibility is disputed, the disagreement should be recorded rather than converted into a finding by repetition.

This is not a retreat from accountability. It is what makes accountability meaningful. An unsupported accusation can be dismissed as an accusation. A carefully sourced question gives an independent reviewer something specific to investigate. The purpose of naming is to establish traceability and responsibility, not to manufacture a verdict.

VI. The paradox of the legacy

Here is the contradiction that has come to define my work. I feel betrayed by people and systems from which I hoped to receive assistance, recognition or fair treatment. Yet I continue to create material that I hope may be useful to other people, including people who may never agree with my account and institutions that may never acknowledge my experience in the terms I would choose.

The Accountability Paradox provides a title for this contradiction: the person who seeks accountability may also be trying to create a record that is useful beyond the immediate dispute. I do not want my suffering to become somebody else's required inheritance. I want the lessons I draw from it to be available for examination, criticism and possible improvement.

A chronology of administrative correspondence may help another researcher understand how to reconstruct a complicated history. A discussion of documentary preservation may help another person retain records that would otherwise be lost. An account of the practical consequences of institutional decisions may prompt questions about safeguards, complaint procedures and access to independent review. These possibilities do not prove that the archive will achieve those outcomes. They explain why I believe the work is worth doing.

I want future advocates to ask better questions. I want researchers to be more careful about the difference between a person's credibility and the quality of the evidence presented. I want institutions to understand that a

complaint is not adequately resolved merely because a response has been sent, nor is an allegation established merely because it has been repeated. I want public archives to make the distinction between source and interpretation unmistakable.

VII. God has my back: the spiritual meaning of survival

My faith is not an incidental ornament attached to the end of my story. It is part of the language through which I understand endurance, purpose and the obligation to continue creating despite disappointment.

When I say, "God has my back," I am expressing a spiritual conviction. I believe that my survival has meaning beyond the recognition society has or has not granted me. I believe that my life should be directed towards truth, preservation, compassion and service. I draw strength from the possibility that suffering need not have the final word about the person who endures it. My belief is testimony about my spiritual understanding, not documentary proof of supernatural intervention or a guarantee of any particular outcome.

I do not need to claim that I can predict the fate of those who have opposed me. I do not need to declare that a person who disagrees with me will be punished by God. I do not need to know the private thoughts of other people to affirm the importance of my faith.

If I believe that my life has been preserved for a purpose, then I must ask what that purpose requires of me now. Does it require me to preserve evidence carefully? Then I must do so. Does it require me to distinguish what I know from what I suspect? Then I must do so. Does it require me to resist the temptation to turn anger into an unsupported accusation? Then I must do so. Does it require me to create something that may help another person, even when I feel that humanity has failed me? Then I must consider how that work can serve others without destroying the person doing it.

My faith cannot substitute for independent verification. It can, however, give me a reason to pursue a standard of conduct that remains meaningful whether or not the world offers recognition. One expresses what I believe my life means. The other preserves what can be examined. Neither needs to impersonate the other.

VIII. The fear of running out of time

The most immediate pressure behind this work is not an abstract argument about history. It is my fear that I may not have the time I hoped I would have. I have described receiving bad news about my health and fearing a fatal prognosis. That is my report of my present circumstances; the actual diagnosis, prognosis and available treatment options must be established through appropriate medical assessment.

The fear has made the unfinished work feel heavier. Every missing link, every unindexed document, every incomplete chronology and every passage that still needs to be written can seem like one more thing I must complete before I lose the opportunity.

But the legacy I want to leave cannot reasonably depend upon my exhausting myself to finish everything. The archive already contains a substantial body of material. The next stage is not simply to produce more words. It is to make the existing record more navigable, preserve original files, connect claims to their sources, identify duplicates and gaps, establish provenance, and distinguish documentary facts from allegations and spiritual interpretations.

A smaller number of well-supported, accessible documents may serve future readers better than a much larger collection that cannot be reliably navigated. I want the work to outlast me, but I do not want the act of preserving it to become the thing that consumes all the time and strength I have left. I want to leave a legacy, and I also want to recognise that my life has value before the legacy is finished. There is no contradiction between preserving a legacy and protecting the life from which it comes.

IX. What history must be allowed to decide

I do not know what future historians will conclude about me. I cannot guarantee that my archive will receive public recognition, that journalists will investigate it, that officials will respond, or that future readers will accept my interpretations. I cannot know whether particular allegations will be substantiated or disproved. I cannot promise that the preservation of records will produce a legal remedy.

What I can do is make it easier for future readers to investigate the questions I have raised. The public repository provides an accessible starting point. Its dated documents record the project's chosen transition from personal testimony towards a documentary witness. They should be read alongside the underlying records, not instead of them.

A future investigator should be able to ask which events are supported by contemporaneous records; which claims have independent corroboration; which allegations remain disputed; which communications establish a particular decision or response; which conclusions depend primarily on my own interpretation; which questions remain unanswered because evidence is incomplete; and what systemic lessons can be drawn without presuming every allegation is established.

I want a reader who disagrees with me to be able to follow the evidence. I want a reader who sympathises with me to be prevented from mistaking sympathy for proof. I want a researcher to identify both the strengths and limitations of the record. My work should be capable of surviving the difference between what I believe today and what the evidence may establish tomorrow.

X. The prophecy of what remains

I return to the image of the witness because it captures the purpose of everything I am trying to preserve. The witness is not necessarily the person who wins the argument in the present. The witness is the person who leaves a record of what they observed, experienced, received, wrote, questioned and attempted to establish. The witness provides material that others can examine. The witness makes it possible for a future inquiry to begin with more than recollection alone.

I have experienced my life as a long struggle against abandonment, misunderstanding and the absence of the acknowledgment I have sought. I have interpreted my survival through faith. I have written about the possibility that institutions can fail people while remaining formally intact. I have assembled documents because I do not want the questions raised by my experiences to vanish with me.

I know that my interpretation is not the same thing as a judicial finding. I know that the presence of a document does not establish every allegation associated with it. I know that an archive is only as useful as its provenance, accessibility, accuracy and willingness to expose its own limitations.

So I will continue to write, but I want the work to become clearer as it grows. I will continue to preserve, but I want preservation to be accompanied by careful indexing and verification. I will continue to express my faith, but I want readers to know when I am speaking spiritually rather than asserting a documentary fact. I will continue to ask for accountability, but I want the questions directed at people and institutions to be supported by identifiable evidence.

I may never receive all the answers I have sought. I may never see every document examined by an independent investigator. I may never know how future readers will interpret the archive. But I can make the record available. I can preserve the distinction between my testimony and an established finding. I can leave the questions where others can find them. I can continue trying to turn what I have endured into something that might help somebody else.

That is the paradox I want history to remember: I feel that humanity has failed me, yet I continue to work for a future in which people may be treated more fairly, records may be examined more carefully, and institutions

may be held more meaningfully accountable. I do not have to pretend that the betrayal I describe has not hurt me. I do not have to deny my exhaustion. I do not have to claim that every suspicion has been proven. I can acknowledge the limits of my knowledge and still insist that my testimony deserves a fair hearing.

I am Dr Barran Dodger. I am the author of this testimony, not the final judge of every question it raises. I have tried to preserve what I believe matters, to document what I can, and to leave future readers a record that does not depend entirely upon my continued presence to explain it. I believe God has sustained me, and I draw strength from that belief. I cannot dictate what history will conclude, but I can refuse to make the evidence disappear simply because the questions remain unresolved. My body may be vulnerable, my time may be uncertain, and my work may remain unfinished. Yet the record can continue to be read, questioned, checked and understood. I wanted my suffering to mean something beyond suffering. I wanted my survival to produce something beyond survival. I wanted to leave humanity something useful, even when I felt abandoned by it. That is the purpose of the witness. That is the responsibility of the archive. That is the legacy I am trying to leave. The witness remains.

Documentary source register

1. Barrandodger public repository: <https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger> — repository structure, README, preservation instructions and catalogue.
2. From Exile to Witness — 4 October 2026:
<https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/FROM-EXILE-TO-WITNESS-4-OCTOBER-2026.pdf>
3. From Exile to Witness: Accountability Paradox: <https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/FROM-EXILE-TO-WITNESS-ACCOUNTABILITY-PARADOX-4-OCTOBER-2026.pdf>
4. Legal Brief — cumulative 35-year record: <https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/Legal%20Brief%20%E2%80%94%20cumulative%2035-year%20record%20.pdf>
5. Accountability, Evidence and Fair Determination: <https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/ACCOUNTABILITY%20AND%20EVIDENCE%20AND%20FAIR%20DETERMINATION.pdf>
6. Functional Erasure — 9 October 2026:
<https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/FUNCTIONAL-ERASURE-9-OCTOBER-2026.pdf>
7. Formal Request for Independent Investigation — Able Point: <https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/FORMAL%20REQUEST%20FOR%20INDEPENDENT%20INVESTIGATION%20ABLEPOINT.pdf>
8. Main archive: <https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/>
9. Rebuild archive: <https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/>

Editorial and evidentiary note

This is a first-person prophetic narrative informed by repository listings and the titles of identifiable records. It is not a forensic finding that every document has been reviewed, nor an independent determination that the allegations are substantiated. Repository-reported file counts should be verified against the live repository. A full evidentiary edition should inspect the contents of each cited PDF and link each factual assertion to the specific passage or underlying record that supports it.

Faith statements are presented as the author's spiritual beliefs. Allegations, interpretations, official determinations and unresolved questions should remain distinct. This document is not a court judgment or a verdict.